

ZTA Workbook

Team answer sheet — one per team. Per use case: map pain → product, list products (how & why), sketch your topology, then your proctor scores it and gives feedback. 100 points per use case.

Team name: _____

Team code: _____

IT Director: _____

Digital Resiliency Officer: _____

Network Architect: _____

Network Security Engineer: _____

How you'll be scored

Associate 60–74

Foundational: identifies the right general Cisco products and meets the basic requirement, but light on *how* and *why*.

Professional 75–89

Solid, correct design: pains mapped to the right products with a clear how & why and a Cisco differentiator; enforcement points shown.

Expert 90–100

Comprehensive & differentiated: every pain/requirement mapped precisely, multiple differentiators, flows traced end-to-end.

Below Associate = Developing (< 60): incomplete or largely incorrect.

CRITERION	MAX	ASSOCIATE	PROFESSIONAL	EXPERT
Pain-point → product mapping	40	20–27 Maps the main pain points to broadly correct products; some gaps or generic choices.	28–34 Maps all pain points to the correct Cisco products, each with a clear reason.	35–40 Every pain mapped precisely to the optimal product with strong justification; no gaps.
Products — how & why / differentiators	30	15–20 Names products; explains “how” only partially; few or no differentiators.	21–26 Correct “how” for each product and a real “why”; at least one Cisco differentiator.	27–30 Precise “how” + compelling “why” for every product; multiple Cisco differentiators vs competitors.
Diagram & overall solution	30	15–20 Diagram present and legible; labels groups; enforcement points partial or unclear.	21–26 Labels groups, marks enforcement points; solution coherent and meets the requirements.	27–30 Traces flow(s) end-to-end with policy/matrix detail; considers integration/edge cases; within budget.

Use Case 1 — Managed Environment — Segmentation

Required

100 pts

The customer's policy is to segment campus & branch wired and wireless client devices (laptops, mobile devices) into logical groups.

▼ Customer requirements & pain points (reference)

Requirements

- Employee and trusted devices (Group=Employees).
- IOT — printers, cameras, badge readers, etc. (Group=IOT).
- Deskside agents — dedicated mac-minis (Group=deskagents).
- Guest SSID for Internet only (Group=Guest).
- IOT should be restricted from the other groups but need data center and Internet access.
- Guests should have Internet access only.
- Employee and IOT require controlled internet, and data center application access.
- Deskside Mac-Minis have access to on-prem data center only.

Pain points

- Prior segmentation failed. Using VLANs/IP subnets is complex and tedious.
- Profiling is labor intensive and staff unable to keep up with constant new devices joining.
- Failing PCI audits.
- Corporate PCs not running latest AntiVirus and OS updates.
- No budget for buying more firewalls to do segmentation.

1 · Pain point → product mapping (40 pts)

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	PROPOSED PRODUCT(S)	HOW IT ADDRESSES / WHY
Prior segmentation failed. Using VLANs/IP subnets is complex and tedious.		
Profiling is labor intensive and staff unable to keep up with constant new devices joining.		
Failing PCI audits.		
Corporate PCs not running latest AntiVirus and OS updates.		
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2 · Products proposed (30 pts)

PRODUCT / FEATURE	DESCRIPTION / HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR

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3 · Proposed topology diagram (30 pts)

Label every group, mark the enforcement point(s), trace one flow end-to-end.

Sketch / attach your diagram here

Proctor: score & level

CRITERION	LEVEL (CIRCLE ONE)	POINTS
Pain → product mapping	☐ A ☐ P ☐ E	/ 40
Products — how & why	☐ A ☐ P ☐ E	/ 30
Diagram & overall solution	☐ A ☐ P ☐ E	/ 30
Total & level	☐ Developing ☐ Associate ☐ Professional ☐ Expert	/ 100

Proctor: feedback

✓ What the team did well

▲ Where they can improve

Use Case 2 — Remote Workers — Zero Trust Access

Required

100 pts

Customer looking for a SASE solution to support remote workers and secure branch connectivity.

▼ Customer requirements & pain points (reference)

Requirements

- All corporate users can use full client VPN to access selected legacy private applications. But most prefer ZTNA for modern applications.
- All corporate users need controlled internet access (block gambling and gaming).
- Contractors can only access private applications via clientless RDP access.
- Improve user experience with minimal application sign-ons.
- Customer wants a SASE solution for branches.

Pain points

- Full client VPN has over-permissive privileges. Not considered Zero Trust.
- User satisfaction is low due to manual VPN connection daily.
- Too many sign-ons per application. Low user satisfaction.
- Want to eliminate password logins to minimize stolen credentials.
- Existing Okta IdP solution getting too expensive.
- CIO wants SASE to reduce branch costs.

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Proctor: feedback**✓ What the team did well**

▲ Where they can improve

Use Case 3 — AI Access and Agent Controls

Required

100 pts

The customer is concerned about uncontrolled AI usage by users from Use Case 2. They want to report what's being used and build enforceable guardrails on what AI tools can do — controlling which AI tools are safe and validating information shared with approved AI sites.

▼ Customer requirements & pain points (reference)

Requirements

- User agents should not be granted rights to use tools equally. Fine-grained control is needed.
- Corporate users should only be able to login to their organization's ChatGPT tenant.
- Some remote users will be running Claude Desktop agents. Ensure your design includes controls for those employee systems.
- Some users will be integrating MCP servers to local agents like Claude Code.

Pain points

- Shadow AI usage is an issue today.
- Too many unknown MCP servers for applications in both the private and public DCs.
- Users using personal credentials for non-enterprise ChatGPT login.
- Downloading of risky AI models.

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Use Case 4 — Merger & Acquisition — Extend Segmentation

Bonus

100 pts

The customer recently acquired a small company (~100 staff) and needs to integrate it into the network as quickly as possible. The remote location has a Cisco FTD as its Internet edge and another segmenting the local AI cluster; the acquired company uses Okta as its IdP.

▼ Customer requirements & pain points (reference)

Requirements

- CISO wants to extend segmentation to the acquired company using TrustSec.
- Only selected branch users can access a restricted resource at the recently acquired company (Site 9951).

Pain points

- Unsure how to extend segmentation to the acquired company.
- Parent company is not ready to add 100 newly acquired staff into their corporate directory. Is there a quick option of using what they already have?
- During transition, minimize disruptive user authentication experience to corporate apps and quickly secure the acquired company apps / user population.
- Acquired company suffered an identity breach previously. Still using passwords.

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Use Case 5 — Zero Trust across Multicloud Data Center

Bonus

100 pts

The customer is challenged with application sprawl across on-prem, AWS and Azure data centers. Propose a strategy and design to identify their applications (including Kubernetes) and minimize the blast radius. A comprehensive segmentation solution including application run-time protection is highly desired.

▼ Customer requirements & pain points (reference)

Requirements

- Limited budget. Want to leverage native security features when practical. Open to virtual appliances.
- CIO seeking an end-to-end segmentation solution.
- Minimize complexity.

Pain points

- Minimal visibility of applications across multicloud data centers.
- Lacking segmentation strategy and plan.
- Wide deployment of Kubernetes with latency and visibility issues.
- Unable to patch IOT devices.
- Too many disparate security management interfaces for on-prem and multicloud enforcement points.

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